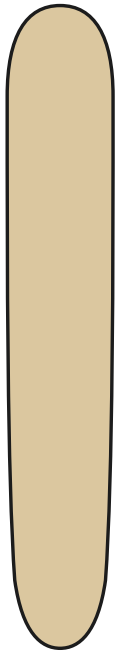


Underbody ×1

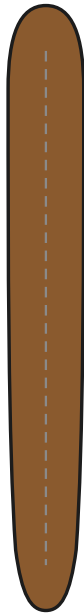
pale tan · cut 1 · actual size



the belly — largest piece

Back ×1

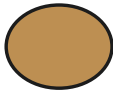
mid brown · cut 1 · actual size



sits on top of the underbody

dashed = centre guide (don't cut)

Head, eyes, antennae



head ×1
golden tan



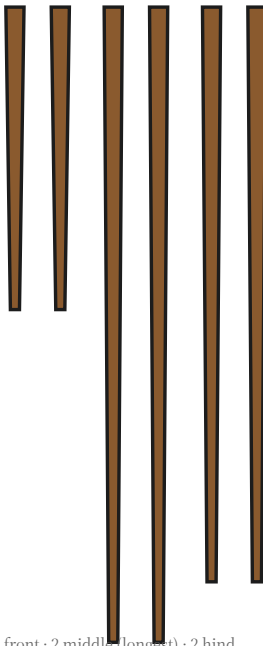
eyes ×2
dark maroon



antennae ×2
dark maroon
cut 2 separate strips

Legs ×6

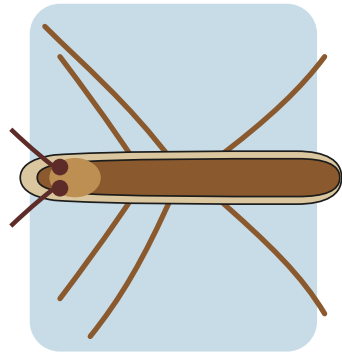
mid brown · actual size



2 front · 2 middle (longest) · 2 hind

Finished!

your River Skater on the mat



slender body, legs splayed wide
middle pair the longest · $\approx 11 \times 9$ cm

The real thing



Aquarius najas — the River Skater, one of Britain's larger pond skaters.

Photo © Alfie Felton, CC0, via iNaturalist. Spotted at Littleborough — about 20 km from Manchester.

How to make it

from your felt squares

- 1 Trace each shape onto the right felt colour.
- 2 Cut out all 13 pieces.
- 3 Build it on the mat →

Felt squares you'll use:

-  pale tan — underbody
-  mid brown — back & legs
-  golden tan — head
-  dark maroon — eyes/antennae

Blue mat/pouch comes premade.

Build it

lay the pieces on the mat

- 1 Lay the blue mat down — that's your pond.
- 2 Place the underbody, then the back on top.
- 3 Add the golden head at the front.

Nothing is fixed — the pieces just sit like a jigsaw.

...and again

it's a puzzle, not a glue-up

- 4 Pop on the 2 eyes and the 2 antennae.
- 5 Tuck the 6 legs under: short pair to the front, long pairs out wide.
- 6 Done! Take it apart and build it all again.

Want it fixed one day? A dab of glue works — but it's made to rebuild.

Did you know?

- It skates on the surface film of ponds and slow rivers.
- Water-repellent leg hairs trap air, so it never sinks.
- It feels ripples in the water to find trapped insects to eat.
- The long middle legs row; the back legs steer.
- One of Britain's largest pond skaters.

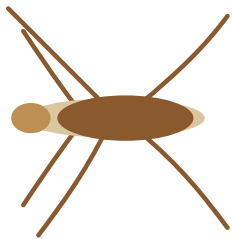


Make your own

River Skater

Instructions

A Giant Insect World felt puzzle
build it · take it apart · build it again



FuzzleWorld

downloadable felt puzzle kits

Collect the set

Meadow · Aquatic · Underground

river skater · dragonfly · bell spider
butterfly · ladybird · more...

Species: Aquarius najas · Photo
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Giant Insect World